[FINAL BOOK TITLE — TO BE DECIDED]

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V.T.R. Ravi Kumar

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The Tamil and English compositions in this book are original literary works. This book is not a translation of the *Thirukkural*, nor does it claim to reproduce Thiruvalluvar's work.

Dedication

[DEDICATION PLACEHOLDER — To be written by the author.]

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Prologue

A human life rarely unfolds as a neat argument. It arrives first as dependence, opens into wonder, and moves through learning, desire, love, work, responsibility, ambition, loss, and change. What seems permanent at one stage may look different from another. What once felt essential may later become a memory; what once seemed like an ending may reveal the beginning of another understanding.

This book follows that long human movement through nine Parts, seventy-two Chapters, and seven hundred and twenty paired compositions. The first eight Parts are organised around broad stages of life, each spanning an imagined eight-year horizon. These stages are a way of arranging reflection, not a rule for how anyone must live. Lives differ. Some experiences arrive early, some late, and some never arrive at all. The questions that shape us, however, often cross the boundaries of age.

The ninth Part steps beyond those stages. It turns towards the freedom that may emerge when wanting loosens its hold, towards stillness, the changing sense of self, the mystery of consciousness, mortality, legacy, and the unknown. It does not presume that every question has a settled answer. In matters of belief and ultimate truth, honest inquiry must leave room for uncertainty.

Tamil and English stand here as equal literary companions. Each pair begins from a shared human insight, but each language is allowed to speak in its own voice. The English composition is not simply a line-by-line translation of the Tamil, nor is the Tamil a rendering of an English original. Their relationship is closer to two perspectives meeting at the same point: connected in meaning, independent in expression.

The discipline of □□□□□ □□□□□□ gives this work an exacting formal aspiration. Its traditional Tamil rules deserve careful attention: sound, □□□, □□□□, □□□, line structure, and the ending of the verse all matter.

The English compositions face a different linguistic reality and must be judged through a separately articulated poetic method, not by pretending that Tamil prosody transfers unchanged into English. Formal claims should be earned through validation, not granted by intention alone.

These compositions are not offered as commandments for every reader. They are invitations to observe: how we become ourselves, what we ask of one another, what we cling to, what we learn to release, and how our understanding changes as the journey continues. A reader may disagree with a thought, find another meaning in it, or carry it into an experience the author never imagined. Such encounters are part of a book's life beyond its writing.

If the earlier Parts look closely at the many things that make a life, the final Part asks what remains when we see those things in perspective. The people who accompany us matter. Our choices matter. Our joys and sorrows matter. Yet love need not mean possession, and letting go need not mean indifference. Perhaps wisdom begins not by denying the journey, but by seeing both its profound value and its impermanence.

The pages that follow are an attempt to look carefully, in two languages, at the life we share and the truths we continue to seek.

Part IX — Bliss, Death and Ultimate Truth

Chapter 65 — The Freedom Beyond Want

Pair 65.1 — Companions, not possessions

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Those who walk beside us shape our days;
No soul is ours to keep against the tide.

Epilogue

[EPILOGUE PLACEHOLDER — To be written after all 720 paired compositions have been completed and reviewed. The epilogue should bring the book's journey together without merely summarising the Chapters or claiming certainty where the work has preserved an open question.]

About the Author

V.T.R. Ravi Kumar is a technologist and writer whose professional life has spanned software engineering, architecture, and emerging technologies. This book brings a different discipline to his work: the pursuit of human insight through the literary possibilities of Tamil and English.

[AUTHOR BIO PLACEHOLDER — Review and finalise the biography, preferred public links, and any author photograph or acknowledgements before publication.]